

Garrett Brownlee
Brooks Brissette
NSC 3120 07
11/07/25

RO Preliminary Write-Up

I will train my rat to successfully walk across a tightrope from one platform to another without falling off. As a reward, I will be using a spoonful of applesauce. Before we begin shaping, I will begin by exposing the rat to the new reward and environment by letting it sit on each platform for 5 minutes each with applesauce freely available. Additionally, I will allocate periods of time for him to rest in his home cage. To initiate training, I will begin by shaping the rat to become comfortable with exploring the tightrope by shaping him to follow the spoonful of applesauce. I will reward him with 3 licks/units of applesauce first when he touches the rope, then when he places two paws on the rope, then when he places his full weight on the rope, followed by his movement halfway down the rope, his movement all the way down the rope, and finally with his movement down and back. I will also switch from a thicker rope to a thinner rope during this process. My materials include a jar of applesauce, a spoon, 2 elevated platforms/a box, tape, a thick rope, a thin rope, and a large plastic tote.

Training Log:

Monday 11/10:

10 min to expose the rat to the new food/environment, 5 min for each of the two platforms

20 min rest time in home cage

10 min to expose the rat to the new food/environment, 5 min for each of the two platforms

Tuesday 11/11:

10 min training to touch the rope with a paw

20 min rest time in home cage

10 min training to touch the rope with a paw

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Wednesday 11/12:

10 min training to touch the rope with two paws

20 min rest time in home cage

10 min training to touch the rope with two paws

Thursday 11/13:

5 min refresher on yesterday's training

10 min training to put full body weight on the rope

15 min rest

10 min training to put full body weight on the rope

Monday 11/17:

5 min refresher on yesterday's training

15 min training to cross the thicker tightrope halfway

10 min rest

20 min training to cross the thicker tightrope halfway

Tuesday 11/18:

5 min refresher on yesterday's training

15 min training to cross the thicker tightrope from one platform to the other

10 min rest

20 min training to cross the thicker tightrope from one platform to the other

Wednesday 11/19:

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5 min refresher on yesterday's training

15 min training to cross the thicker tightrope from one platform to the other

10 min rest

20 min training to cross the thicker tightrope from one platform to the other

Thursday 11/20:

5 min refresher on yesterday's training

15 min training to cross the thinner tightrope from one platform to the other

10 min rest

20 min training to cross the thinner tightrope from one platform to the other

Monday 12/1:

5 min refresher on yesterday's training

15 min training to cross from one platform to the other and then back to the start platform

10 min rest

20 min training to cross from one platform to the other and then back to the start platform

Tuesday 12/2:

5 min refresher on yesterday's training

15 min training to cross from one platform to the other and then back to the start platform

10 min rest

20 min training to cross from one platform to the other and then back to the start platform